PART IX · GOING FURTHER · 1

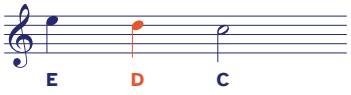
Notes outside the chord

Under a tune, the chord holds the main notes. The other notes of the tune are **non-chord notes**: they lean on the chord for a moment, then step back into it. Name them, and you know which notes to shape and which to rest on.

THE SECRET

A note outside the chord moves by step: into the chord, out of it, or both.

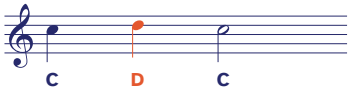
Passing note



over C

steps **between** two chord notes

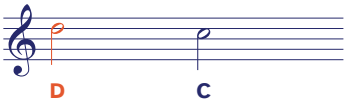
Auxiliary note



over C

steps **out and back** to the same note

Appoggiatura



over C

leans on the beat, then steps into the chord

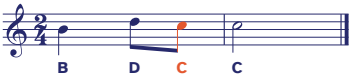
Suspension



F chord, then C

is **held over** from the last chord, then falls

Anticipation



G chord, then C

arrives **early**, before its chord

Five ways out of the chord and back. Red: outside the chord.

1. Name the **chord** under the bar: its three notes.
2. Mark every tune note that is **not** one of them.
3. Look how it **moves in and out**: that gives its name.
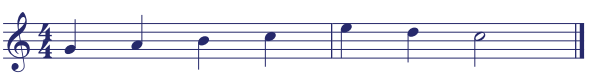
The five at a glance

NAME	HOW IT MOVES	BEAT	ALSO CALLED
Passing note	steps between two chord notes, going the same way	usually weak	—
Auxiliary note	steps away from a chord note and back to it	usually weak	neighbour note
Appoggiatura	lands on the strong beat and leans, then steps into the chord	strong	from Italian *appoggiare*, to lean
Suspension	held over from the last chord, then falls by step	strong	prepared, held, resolved
Anticipation	a note of the next chord, sounded early	weak	—

PART IX · GOING FURTHER · 1 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE

Which notes are outside the chord? The chord is C



1 **The chord is C**: C, E and G.
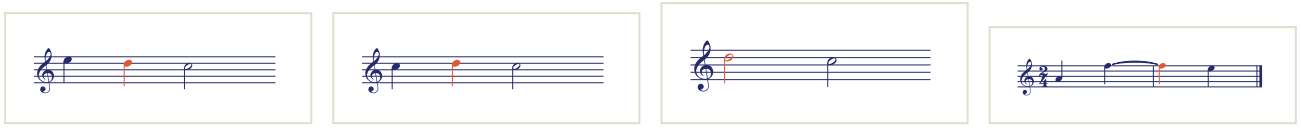
2 **Mark every note** that is not C, E or G.

3 **How does each one move?**

A and B: two passing notes from G up to C (B falls on beat 3, and still passes). In bar 2, D passes from E down to C.

GAME

Name it

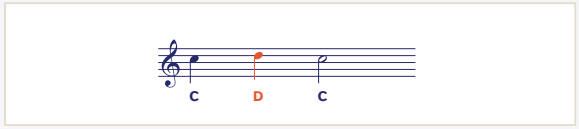


1 2 3 4

Passing, auxiliary, appoggiatura or suspension? The chord is C (in 4: F, then C).

Answer: 1 passing · 2 auxiliary · 3 appoggiatura · 4 suspension

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Play C D C, then C B C, over a C chord.

Out and straight back: two auxiliary notes.

YOU KNOW THIS

Ode to Joy (Beethoven)



Bar 1 sits on C (C E G). The **F** steps from E up to G: a **passing note**.

Try it. Play bar 1 with a C chord in the left hand and hear the F slip between E and G.

THINK OF IT Stepping stones in a stream: the chord is the bank. Step onto a stone for a moment, then land on the bank again.

TRAP

× Calling a note outside the chord a mistake: it is the tune's colour. It almost always moves by step.

× Choosing a chord for a passing note: choose for the main notes.

SEE ALSO

Chords under a melody p. 142 · Chords in a key p. 116 · Ornaments p. 88

PRACTISE IT

Workbook pp. 1–2 · Online: Library › Non-chord notes